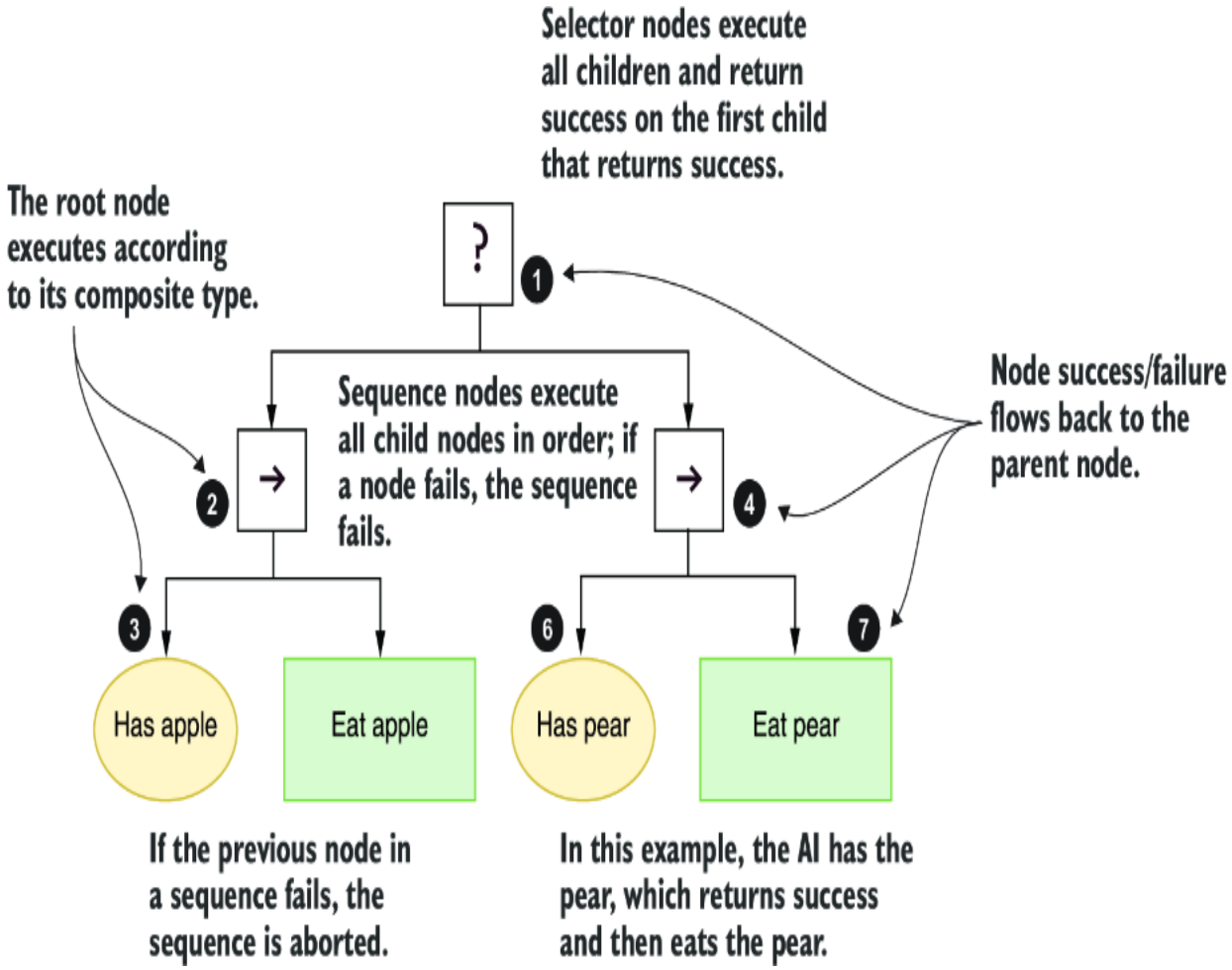


Figure 6.2 The execution process of a simple behavior tree

Behavior trees provide control over how an AI system will execute at a macro or micro level. Regarding robotics, behavior trees will typically be designed to operate at the micro level, where each action or condition is a small event, such as detecting the apple. Conversely, behavior trees can also control more macro systems, such as NPCs in games, where each action may be a combination of events, like attacking the player.

For agentic systems, behavior trees support controlling an agent or assistant at your chosen level. We'll explore controlling agents at the task and, in later chapters, the planning levels. After all, with the power of LLMs, agents can construct their own behavior tree.

Of course, several other forms of AI control could be used to control agentic systems. The next section will examine those different systems and compare them to behavior trees.